

## Boss Challenge - Paper 08 (Class 7)

Acids, Bases & Salts | Electric Current & its Effects | Algebraic Expressions | Exponents & Powers  
One correct option each. Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 blank. Write A/B/C/D on a separate sheet.

1. A liquid turns blue litmus red but leaves red litmus unchanged. What can you safely conclude?  
(A) It is basic.  
(B) It is a salt and so always basic.  
(C) It is acidic.  
(D) It is neutral.
2. In the term  $-7xy$ , the numerical coefficient is:  
(A)  $xy$   
(B)  $-7$   
(C)  $7$   
(D)  $-7xy$
3. In a circuit diagram, a long thin line next to a short thick line represents:  
(A) a resistor  
(B) a switch  
(C) a bulb  
(D) a cell
4. The expression  $2^5$  means:  
(A)  $5 \times 5$   
(B)  $2 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 2$   
(C) 2 multiplied by itself five times ( $2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 2$ )  
(D)  $2 \times 5$
5. Phenolphthalein stays colourless in liquid X. When X is added to a pink phenolphthalein-base mixture, the pink fades. X is most likely:  
(A) an acid  
(B) pure water  
(C) a strong base  
(D) a basic salt
6. Which pair are LIKE terms?  
(A)  $5x^2$  and  $5x$   
(B)  $2xy$  and  $2x$   
(C)  $3a$  and  $3b$   
(D)  $3ab$  and  $-7ba$
7. Two or more cells joined together form a:  
(A) battery  
(B) filament  
(C) fuse  
(D) switch
8. The value of  $3^4$  is:  
(A) 27  
(B) 12  
(C) 64  
(D) 81

9. An ant's sting injects formic acid into the skin. The best quick remedy from the kitchen is to rub on:
- (A) lemon juice
  - (B) vinegar
  - (C) common salt solution
  - (D) baking soda (a mild base)
10. If  $x = 2$  and  $y = 3$ , the value of  $2x^2 - y$  is:
- (A) -1
  - (B) 5
  - (C) 10
  - (D) 13
11. To make a working battery, cells are joined so that:
- (A) the positive terminal of one cell connects to the negative terminal of the next
  - (B) the negative terminal joins the negative terminal
  - (C) the terminals are left unconnected
  - (D) the positive terminal joins the positive terminal
12. Using the laws of exponents,  $3^2 \times 3^3$  equals:
- (A)  $3^5$
  - (B)  $3^1$
  - (C)  $9^5$
  - (D)  $3^6$
13. Which group contains only acids?
- (A) curd, soap solution, orange
  - (B) lemon, vinegar, milk of magnesia
  - (C) ant sting, lime water, spinach
  - (D) lemon (citric), vinegar (acetic), tamarind (tartaric)
14. Sohan is 5 years older than twice Ravi's age. If Ravi is  $r$  years old, Sohan's age is:
- (A)  $5r + 2$
  - (B)  $r + 5$
  - (C)  $2r + 5$
  - (D)  $2(r + 5)$
15. When current passes through a wire and makes it hot, this is called the:
- (A) heating effect of current
  - (B) chemical effect of current
  - (C) magnetic effect of current
  - (D) lighting effect of current
16. Using the laws of exponents,  $5^7 / 5^4$  equals:
- (A)  $5^{(7/4)}$
  - (B)  $1^3$
  - (C)  $5^3$
  - (D)  $5^{11}$
17. A drop of soap solution on a yellow turmeric stain turns the stain red. This shows soap solution is:
- (A) neutral
  - (B) basic
  - (C) acidic
  - (D) a salt with no effect

18. How many terms are in the expression  $4x^2 - 3xy + 7$  ?
- (A) 1
  - (B) 3
  - (C) 4
  - (D) 2
19. Equal currents pass through a thick copper wire and a thin nichrome wire. Which gets hotter?
- (A) the thick copper wire
  - (B) both heat equally
  - (C) neither heats at all
  - (D) the thin nichrome wire
20. The value of  $(2^3)^2$  is:
- (A) 2
  - (B) 64
  - (C) 12
  - (D) 32
21. When an acid reacts completely with a base, the products are always:
- (A) hydrogen gas and a salt
  - (B) a salt and water
  - (C) two salts
  - (D) a base and water
22. Subtract  $(3a - 2b)$  from  $(5a + b)$ .
- (A)  $-2a - 3b$
  - (B)  $8a - b$
  - (C)  $2a - 3b$
  - (D)  $2a + 3b$
23. The filament of an electric bulb glows mainly because:
- (A) the glass cover gets hot
  - (B) the bulb is filled with water
  - (C) current heats the thin high-resistance filament until it gives out light
  - (D) the switch becomes a magnet
24. Any non-zero number raised to the power 0 equals:
- (A) 1
  - (B) undefined
  - (C) 0
  - (D) the number itself
25. A farmer's field is too acidic for crops. The correct substance to add to the soil is:
- (A) vinegar
  - (B) common salt
  - (C) slaked lime (a base)
  - (D) an acid fertiliser
26. Simplify:  $7x - 3x + 2 - 5$ .
- (A)  $4x - 3$
  - (B)  $10x - 3$
  - (C)  $4x + 3$
  - (D)  $4x - 7$

27. A fuse protects an electrical circuit because it:
- (A) increases the current in the circuit
  - (B) stores electric charge for later
  - (C) melts and breaks the circuit when the current becomes too large
  - (D) makes the bulb glow brighter
28. The value of  $(-1)^{100}$  is:
- (A) -1
  - (B) 1
  - (C) -100
  - (D) 100
29. China rose indicator turns a solution green. The solution must be:
- (A) acidic
  - (B) always a salt
  - (C) neutral
  - (D) basic
30. The expression  $3(2x + 4)$  is equal to:
- (A)  $6x + 12$
  - (B)  $6x + 4$
  - (C)  $6x + 7$
  - (D)  $5x + 7$
31. A fuse wire is deliberately made of a metal that melts easily so that:
- (A) the current in the circuit increases
  - (B) the wire becomes a permanent magnet
  - (C) it breaks the circuit before the appliance's own wires overheat
  - (D) the bulb glows brighter
32. The value of  $(-1)^{101}$  is:
- (A) 101
  - (B) -101
  - (C) -1
  - (D) 1
33. Why must a factory neutralise its acidic waste before letting it flow into a river?
- (A) to remove the acid's harmful effect and protect aquatic life
  - (B) because salts always evaporate
  - (C) to make the water taste sweet
  - (D) to increase the acid's strength
34. In  $5x^2 - 2x + 9$ , the constant term is:
- (A)  $x$
  - (B) -2
  - (C) 5
  - (D) 9
35. A compass needle near a wire deflects only when the switch is ON. This shows that:
- (A) the wire is charged like a rubbed balloon
  - (B) the compass is faulty
  - (C) an electric current produces a magnetic effect
  - (D) current produces only heat

36. The number 47000 written in standard form is:
- (A)  $4.7 \times 10^4$
  - (B)  $4.7 \times 10^3$
  - (C)  $0.47 \times 10^5$
  - (D)  $47 \times 10^3$
37. Fresh milk is almost neutral, but on standing it slowly turns sour. The best explanation is that:
- (A) an acid (lactic acid) forms in it
  - (B) a base forms in it
  - (C) it turns into pure water
  - (D) a salt forms and makes it sour
38. The perimeter of a rectangle with length  $l$  and breadth  $b$  is given by the expression:
- (A)  $l \times b$
  - (B)  $2(l + b)$
  - (C)  $2l + b$
  - (D)  $l + b$
39. A coil of wire wound around an iron nail acts as a magnet ONLY while current flows. This device is a/an:
- (A) permanent magnet
  - (B) electromagnet
  - (C) fuse
  - (D) cell
40. The number  $5.2 \times 10^3$  equals:
- (A) 5.2000
  - (B) 520
  - (C) 5200
  - (D) 52000
41. An antacid tablet relieves acidity in the stomach because it:
- (A) is a mild base that neutralises excess stomach acid
  - (B) is a neutral salt that absorbs water
  - (C) adds more acid to digest food
  - (D) is a strong acid that burns the germs
42. Joined squares in a row need  $3n + 1$  matchsticks for  $n$  squares. How many sticks are needed for 10 squares?
- (A) 31
  - (B) 30
  - (C) 34
  - (D) 40
43. Which change makes an electromagnet STRONGER?
- (A) switching off the current
  - (B) removing the iron core
  - (C) using fewer turns
  - (D) increasing the number of turns in the coil
44. Which is greater,  $2^5$  or  $5^2$ ?
- (A)  $5^2$
  - (B) they are equal
  - (C)  $2^5$
  - (D) they cannot be compared

45. Which liquid is most likely to leave BOTH red and blue litmus unchanged?
- (A) distilled water
  - (B) lemon juice
  - (C) soap solution
  - (D) baking soda solution
46. Which of the following is a MONOMIAL?
- (A)  $a + b + c$
  - (B)  $x + y$
  - (C)  $2x - 3$
  - (D)  $-6x^2y$
47. The main advantage of an electromagnet over a permanent magnet is that:
- (A) it cannot attract iron
  - (B) it never needs any current
  - (C) its magnetism can be switched on and off
  - (D) it is always weaker than any magnet
48.  $(2 \times 3)^2$  is equal to:
- (A)  $2 \times 3^2 = 18$
  - (B)  $2^2 \times 3^2 = 36$
  - (C)  $2^2 \times 3 = 12$
  - (D)  $2 \times 3 \times 2 = 12$
49. You have one bottle of dilute acid and one of dilute base, but ONLY red litmus paper. Which can you definitely identify?
- (A) both, immediately
  - (B) the base, because it turns red litmus blue
  - (C) the acid, because it turns red litmus blue
  - (D) neither, you always need blue litmus
50. The factors of the term  $5xy$  are:
- (A)  $5x$  and  $5y$
  - (B)  $5$ ,  $x$  and  $y$
  - (C)  $5$  and  $xy$  only
  - (D)  $x$  and  $y$  only
51. An electric bell works mainly using the \_\_\_\_\_ effect of current.
- (A) magnetic
  - (B) chemical
  - (C) cooling
  - (D) heating
52. Expressed as a product of prime powers, 72 equals:
- (A)  $2^4 \times 3$
  - (B)  $2^3 \times 3^3$
  - (C)  $2^2 \times 3^3$
  - (D)  $2^3 \times 3^2$
53. Equal strengths of an acid and a base are mixed to give a neutral solution. A little MORE acid is then added. The mixture becomes:
- (A) turned into pure salt only
  - (B) acidic
  - (C) basic
  - (D) still perfectly neutral

54. If  $a = -2$ , the value of  $a^2 + 3a$  is:
- (A) 10
  - (B) 2
  - (C) -2
  - (D) -10
55. If the switch in a single-loop circuit is left OPEN, the bulb will:
- (A) not glow, because the circuit is incomplete
  - (B) glow brighter than before
  - (C) glow dimly
  - (D) become a magnet
56. Using the laws of exponents,  $10^3 \times 10^2 \times 10$  equals:
- (A)  $10^7$
  - (B)  $100^6$
  - (C)  $10^6$
  - (D)  $10^5$
57. Many toothpastes are mildly basic. The main reason is to:
- (A) dissolve the enamel faster
  - (B) make the mouth strongly acidic
  - (C) add sugar to feed bacteria
  - (D) neutralise the acid made by mouth bacteria
58. Add the expressions  $2x^2 + 3x$  and  $x^2 - x + 4$ .
- (A)  $3x^2 + 4x + 4$
  - (B)  $3x^2 + 2x + 4$
  - (C)  $3x^2 + 2x - 4$
  - (D)  $2x^2 + 2x + 4$
59. In a circuit two bulbs are connected one after another (in series). If one bulb fuses, the other bulb will:
- (A) glow much brighter
  - (B) turn into a fuse
  - (C) also stop glowing, because the circuit is broken
  - (D) be completely unaffected
60. The value of  $7^5 / 7^5$  is:
- (A) 7
  - (B) 0
  - (C)  $7^{10}$
  - (D) 1
61. Which of these is a base?
- (A) caustic soda (sodium hydroxide)
  - (B) common salt
  - (C) citric acid
  - (D) vinegar
62. In the expression  $x^2 - x$ , the coefficient of  $x$  is:
- (A) -1
  - (B)  $x$
  - (C) 1
  - (D) 0

63. Adding one more cell (connected correctly) to a torch usually makes the bulb:
- (A) exactly the same
  - (B) magnetic instead of bright
  - (C) dimmer
  - (D) brighter, because more current flows
64. A distance is written as  $9 \times 10^7$  km. Written in full, this is:
- (A) 9,000,000 km
  - (B) 79,000,000 km
  - (C) 90,000,000 km
  - (D) 900,000,000 km
65. Common salt is dissolved in water. The solution will be:
- (A) able to turn blue litmus red
  - (B) strongly acidic
  - (C) neutral
  - (D) strongly basic
66. A hall has  $c$  chairs (4 legs each) and  $t$  stools (3 legs each). The total number of legs is:
- (A)  $3c + 4t$
  - (B)  $4c + 3$
  - (C)  $7(c + t)$
  - (D)  $4c + 3t$
67. The heating element of an electric room heater is made of nichrome because nichrome:
- (A) is naturally magnetic
  - (B) has a high resistance and a high melting point
  - (C) is a poor conductor that blocks current completely
  - (D) melts very easily
68. Which of the following equals 64?
- (A)  $2^5$
  - (B)  $2^6$
  - (C)  $4^4$
  - (D)  $3^4$
69. Litmus, the most common natural indicator, is obtained from:
- (A) lichens
  - (B) rose petals
  - (C) only red cabbage
  - (D) turmeric roots
70. Which two terms CANNOT be added together (they are unlike)?
- (A)  $x$  and  $4x$
  - (B)  $-3ab$  and  $ab$
  - (C)  $6x^2$  and  $6x$
  - (D)  $2y$  and  $5y$
71. Why should you NEVER touch an electric switch with wet hands?
- (A) water cools the switch and breaks it
  - (B) water lets electricity pass through you easily, risking a dangerous shock
  - (C) wet hands repel electric current
  - (D) wet hands turn into magnets



72. Since  $a^3 = a \times a \times a$ , the product  $a^3 \times a^2$  is the same as:
- (A)  $a^6$
  - (B)  $a^9$
  - (C)  $a^1$
  - (D)  $a \times a \times a \times a \times a = a^5$
73. Plants are dying in a strongly BASIC soil. Which addition best moves the soil towards neutral?
- (A) organic manure / compost
  - (B) slaked lime
  - (C) baking soda
  - (D) caustic soda
74. The cost in rupees of  $x$  pencils at Rs 4 each plus one Rs 10 eraser is  $C = 4x + 10$ . The cost of 7 pencils and one eraser is:
- (A) Rs 38
  - (B) Rs 40
  - (C) Rs 28
  - (D) Rs 48
75. An electromagnet uses a soft iron core rather than a steel core because soft iron:
- (A) loses its magnetism quickly when the current is switched off
  - (B) conducts no electric current
  - (C) cannot be magnetised at all
  - (D) stays a magnet forever after one use
76. Six lakh forty thousand (6,40,000) written in standard form is:
- (A)  $64 \times 10^4$
  - (B)  $0.64 \times 10^6$
  - (C)  $6.4 \times 10^4$
  - (D)  $6.4 \times 10^5$
77. Phenolphthalein is pink in a solution. Which single action will most likely turn it colourless?
- (A) cooling the solution
  - (B) adding common salt
  - (C) adding more base
  - (D) adding enough acid
78. Simplify:  $3a + 4b - a + 2b$ .
- (A)  $4a + 6b$
  - (B)  $2a + 6b$
  - (C)  $2a - 6b$
  - (D)  $2a + 2b$
79. Which device works mainly on the MAGNETIC effect of current?
- (A) an electric bulb
  - (B) an electromagnet crane lifting scrap iron
  - (C) an electric iron (press)
  - (D) a room heater
80.  $(5^2)^3$  has the same value as:
- (A)  $5^5$
  - (B)  $5^8$
  - (C)  $5^6$
  - (D)  $5^{23}$

81. Pouring vinegar on baking soda makes bubbles of gas. This tells us that vinegar is:
- (A) neutral
  - (B) basic
  - (C) acidic
  - (D) a metal
82. Which expression is a BINOMIAL?
- (A)  $2x - 5$
  - (B)  $3xy$
  - (C)  $a + b + c$
  - (D) 7
83. Which appliance works mainly on the HEATING effect of current?
- (A) an electromagnet crane
  - (B) a compass near a wire
  - (C) an electric bell
  - (D) an electric toaster
84. Without multiplying it all out, the sign of  $(-2)^6$  is:
- (A) cannot be decided without full multiplication
  - (B) negative
  - (C) positive
  - (D) zero
85. Which one of these statements about acids and bases is correct?
- (A) Bases turn blue litmus red.
  - (B) Acids turn blue litmus red; bases turn red litmus blue.
  - (C) Neutral liquids turn both litmus papers red.
  - (D) Acids turn red litmus blue.
86. If  $p = 3$ , the value of  $2p^2$  is:
- (A) 18
  - (B) 9
  - (C) 12
  - (D) 36
87. In a circuit diagram, an OPEN switch means the switch is:
- (A) a cell that supplies current
  - (B) OFF, so current cannot flow
  - (C) ON, so current flows freely
  - (D) a fuse that has melted
88. Which is greater,  $3^4$  or  $4^3$ ?
- (A) they are equal
  - (B)  $4^3$
  - (C) they cannot be compared
  - (D)  $3^4$
89. Lime water turns red litmus blue. This tells us that lime water is:
- (A) an acid
  - (B) neutral
  - (C) a strong acid like a lemon
  - (D) a base

90. A taxi charges Rs 30 fixed plus Rs 12 per km. For a ride of  $d$  km the fare in rupees is:
- (A)  $30d + 12$
  - (B)  $42d$
  - (C)  $12d + 30$
  - (D)  $12 + 30d$
91. A torch bulb will not light even with a brand-new bulb and the switch closed. The MOST likely cause is:
- (A) the bulb is too new to work
  - (B) the connecting wire is too short
  - (C) there is too much magnetism in the wire
  - (D) the cells are used up, so no current flows
92. Simplify  $2^8 / (2^3 \times 2^2)$ .
- (A)  $2^{(8/5)}$
  - (B)  $2^3 = 6$
  - (C)  $2^3 (= 8)$
  - (D)  $2^{13}$
93. Solution X turns china rose magenta; solution Y turns turmeric red. X and Y are respectively:
- (A) both acids
  - (B) both bases
  - (C) a base and an acid
  - (D) an acid and a base
94. On collecting like terms,  $5xy + 3x - 2xy + x$  equals:
- (A)  $3xy + 3x$
  - (B)  $7xy + 4x$
  - (C)  $3xy + 4x$
  - (D)  $3xy + 2x$
95. An appliance normally draws a working current of about 5 A. For safety, the fuse fitted to it should melt at a current that is:
- (A) a little above the normal working current (just over 5 A)
  - (B) far below the normal working current
  - (C) exactly zero amperes
  - (D) as high as possible so it never melts
96. A number in standard form is written as  $k \times 10^n$ . The value of  $k$  must satisfy:
- (A)  $k$  is always greater than 10
  - (B)  $1 \leq k < 10$
  - (C)  $k$  is exactly 10
  - (D)  $k$  can be any whole number
97. A factory releases BASIC waste water. To make it safe before release, the cheapest correct choice is to add a/an:
- (A) common salt
  - (B) stronger base
  - (C) only fresh water
  - (D) acid
98. For the cost expression  $8n$  ( $n$  notebooks at Rs 8 each), which statement is correct?
- (A) Both 8 and  $n$  are constants.
  - (B) 8 is the fixed price per notebook (a constant) and  $n$  is the variable number of notebooks.
  - (C) 8 is the number of notebooks and  $n$  is the price.
  - (D) Both 8 and  $n$  are variables.

99. In a simple circuit, conventional current is taken to flow through the wire starting from the:

- (A) negative terminal of the cell
- (B) positive terminal of the cell
- (C) both terminals at once
- (D) middle of the connecting wire

100. Light travels about  $3 \times 10^5$  km in one second. In 2 seconds it travels:

- (A)  $3 \times 10^{25}$  km
- (B)  $6 \times 10^5$  km
- (C)  $3 \times 10^{10}$  km
- (D)  $6 \times 10^{10}$  km